



DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF NAVAL OPERATIONS
2000 NAVY PENTAGON
WASHINGTON DC 20350-2000

OPNAVINST 5400.46A
N13F
18 May 2021

OPNAV INSTRUCTION 5400.46A

From: Chief of Naval Operations

Subj: COMMAND LANGUAGE PROGRAMS AND AWARDS

Ref: (a) DoDI 5160.70 of 30 December 2016
(b) SECNAV M-1650.1 of August 2019

Encl: (1) Navy Individual Language Awards - Sample Nomination Package

1. Purpose.

a. To establish policies and procedures and to provide guidelines for planning, developing and implementing Navy command language programs and awards.

b. This revision incorporates three instructions providing overall policy for command language programs as well as Navy language awards for commands and individuals. The revised title reflects the additional content.

c. This revision establishes the annual due date of 31 March for submission of nomination packages for Command Language Program of the Year and individual language awards. The change aligns Navy's award submission deadline with that established annually by the Defense Language Institute Foreign Language Center (DLIFLC) for Department of Defense (DoD)-level awards.

d. This revision specifies the award level for military recipients of Navy individual language awards and modifies the award for Navy civilian recipients. Additionally, it renames the Navy Language Professional of the Year award in honor of Senior Chief Cryptologic Technician Interpretive Shannon M. Kent, who was killed in action in January 2019.

2. Cancellation. OPNAVINST 5400.46, Command Language Program, OPNAVINST 1650.31, Command Language Program of the Year and OPNAVINST 1650.32, Navy Language Professional and Navy Linguist of the Year.

3. Scope and Applicability. This instruction applies to all Navy personnel, including the Active Component (AC), Reserve Component (RC) and civilian workforce.

4. Policy. It is DoD and Navy policy that foreign language skills, regional expertise and cultural capabilities are enduring critical competencies, which are mission-essential and must be managed to maximize the accession, development, sustainment, enhancement and employment of these vital skills.

5. Background.

a. Reference (a) provides overall policy on the DoD Language, Regional Expertise and Culture (LREC) program management and directs services to develop, resource and establish policies, plans and programs to enhance language proficiency, regional expertise and cultural knowledge across the Total Force. In line with reference (a), services must ensure commands or units with foreign language-coded billets establish a command language program and designate a command language program manager (CLPM). Section 11 of reference (a) describes procedures for establishing and managing command language programs, which provide vital support for meeting language mission requirements.

b. The Chief of Naval Operations (CNO) established the Language Professional and Linguist of the Year awards to recognize AC, RC and civilian personnel who have distinguished themselves through use of foreign language skills to support Navy's mission to maintain, train and equip combat-ready Naval forces capable of winning wars, deterring aggression and maintaining freedom of the seas.

c. CNO established the Command Language Program of the Year award as an annual recognition of the top command language programs in the Navy.

d. The individual awards described in this instruction are consistent with the policies in reference (b).

6. Discussion. A command language program is any foreign language training program or tool for managing language-enabled personnel. A unit's language mission will dictate the kind of command language program required.

a. Command language programs support mission requirements by facilitating acquisition, sustainment and enhancement of language skills, monitoring language capability within an organization, reporting the status of LREC readiness and recognizing excellence in language utilization. A command language program must be sufficiently staffed by qualified personnel, who are dedicated to supporting the command's foreign language-enabled Sailors, implementing Navy LREC initiatives and complying with applicable directives.

b. DLIFLC Pamphlet 350-9, Guidelines, Policies and Procedures for DoD Command Language Programs and DLIFLC Pamphlet 351-1, Sustaining Field Assistance Visit Concept and Evaluation Guidelines for DoD Command Language Programs provide comprehensive policies, procedures and guidelines for establishment, maintenance and evaluation of command language programs.

7. Responsibilities.

a. Navy Senior Language Authority and Director, Navy LREC Office (OPNAV N13F). OPNAV N13F provides overall guidance on Navy command language programs for and manages Navy language awards. OPNAV N13F must:

- (1) Define program policy and overall program direction.
- (2) Provide oversight and guidance for command language programs.
- (3) Serve as the primary source of information on LREC programs in Navy and provide assistance, as requested, to commands establishing, developing and executing a command language program.
- (4) Compile and analyze information on Navy LREC readiness and make recommendations as appropriate to Navy and DoD leadership.
- (5) Serve as CLPM for the foreign area officer (FAO) community.
- (6) Serve as CLPM for AC and RC Cryptologic Technicians Interpretive (CTI) assigned to billets outside of the Naval Information Force (NAVIFOR) and Naval Information Force Reserve domains.

b. Commands or units with language-coded billets. All commands or units with billets coded for language must establish a command language program, separate and distinct from existing command training programs. Commanding officers (CO) or officers in charge (OIC) must:

- (1) Institute a language-training program to enhance the command's ability to meet its language mission requirements.
- (2) Designate, in writing, a CLPM, who must be an E-6 or above with proven leadership skills and an understanding of language requirements and training. This position may be a collateral duty, but should be a permanent, full-time position in commands with more than 50 language-coded billets.
- (3) Document language readiness and accomplishments in fitness reports and evaluations, when appropriate and as required for CTIs.
- (4) Ensure adequate testing capability is established, to include a qualified test control officer and test administrators, when demand for language testing dictates.

c. Commands or units with more than 50 language-coded billets. In commands or units with more than 50 language-coded billets, COs or OICs must:

(1) Establish a command language council made up of the CO or OIC, executive officer or assistant OIC, command master chief, command training officer and CLPM. The command language council must:

(a) Meet regularly to ensure visibility for the program, command emphasis and sufficient support for the needs of the Sailors served by it.

(b) Facilitate integration of the command language program with other education, training and operational requirements and resources.

(c) Address language matters such as training, readiness, language proficiency testing status, foreign language proficiency bonus, language awards and any other issues relevant to the command language program.

(2) Designate assistant CLPMs when the linguist population warrants, for example in commands with a significant number of assigned language professionals.

d. Commands with assigned language professionals. Commands with assigned CTIs report overall accomplishments of the command language program via the chain of command to the type commander. Type commanders coordinate with OPNAV N13F to provide language readiness and command language program information at least annually.

e. CLPMs. CLPMs must:

(1) Manage programmatic aspects of the command language program to include foreign language training and testing.

(2) Carry out language training and readiness functions as assigned by the CO or OIC.

(3) Develop and maintain individual language training plans for language professionals and any Sailor filling a billet requiring language skills.

(4) Execute a language-training program to enhance the command's ability to meet its language mission requirements.

(a) For commands or units with language professionals assigned, this program must include a requirement for no less than two hours per week of language maintenance training and at least 120 hours for language enhancement events every two years or as required by DoD instruction.

(b) For commands or units with Sailors filling language-coded billets, who are not language professionals, the command language program should encourage no less than two hours per week of language maintenance training and provide guidance on language training materials and opportunities as available.

(5) Maintain a command language database to include information on training accomplishment, language test scores, Sailors with self-assessed language ability and other pertinent language readiness data.

(6) Coordinate language proficiency testing under OPNAVINST 5200.37, Navy Foreign Language Testing Program, the Navy foreign language testing program instruction, for all command Sailors proficient in a foreign language.

(7) Document the overall accomplishments of the command language program and provide the information to the CO or OIC.

(8) Schedule LREC training for CTIs through Navy's Center for Information Warfare Training (CIWT) via NAVIFOR or Naval Information Force Reserve.

(9) Schedule LREC training for Sailors, who are not language professionals, through CIWT, as directed by the CO or OIC.

(10) Ensure COs are fully informed of the command's operational language capabilities.

(11) Ensure all Sailors checking into the command are screened for language capability.

(12) Submit command members and command language program for annual language community awards, when warranted.

f. Assistant CLPMs. Assistant CLPMs, when assigned, must:

(1) Coordinate language testing with the CLPM and service members to ensure language testing and training periods are not in conflict with leave and deployment dates.

(2) Aid in the maintenance of command LREC records.

(3) Provide defense language proficiency test scores to leadership for inclusion in mid-term counseling and evaluations, as appropriate.

(4) Provide input to the CLPM for issues involving language testing or training and any requiring the attention of the command language council.

(5) Assist the CLPM by compiling and providing any command language program data required for reports or inquiries.

g. CIWT. For language professionals, DLIFLC provides CLPM training aligned with DLIFLC Pamphlet 350-9, Guidelines, Policies and Procedures for DOD Command Language Programs. Additionally, CIWT must provide initial CLPM training for Navy's non-language professional CLPMs including information regarding: language testing, language awards, reporting of foreign language capabilities, foreign language proficiency bonus, ordering of LREC training materials and roles and responsibilities of LREC offices within the Department of the Navy.

8. Procedures. OPNAV N13F is responsible for Navy language award policy and management of the Navy Command Language Program of the Year and individual language award programs. CLPMs must submit command members and command language programs for annual language awards, when warranted. This section describes Navy language awards and outlines award submission procedures.

a. Command Language Program of the Year. The CNO established the Command Language Program of the Year award as an annual recognition of the top Navy command language programs.

(1) Selection Criteria. This award recognizes accomplishments over one fiscal year. In the nomination package, commands must describe efforts made during the preceding fiscal year. DLIFLC Pamphlet 350-9, Guidelines, Policies and Procedures for DoD Command Language Programs and DLIFLC Pamphlet 351-1, Sustaining Field Assistance Visit Concept and Evaluation Guidelines for DoD Command Language Programs both provide guidelines for development of a successful command language program and program evaluation criteria. At a minimum, the nomination package should provide descriptions of program elements and associated data as listed in paragraphs 8a(1)(a) through 8a(1)(g).

(a) CO or OIC description of the command language program.

(b) Command language council activities, if applicable.

(c) Language proficiency test results, including trend data as the results relate to training opportunities and type of instruction (e.g., distance learning, formal classroom instruction and length of instruction) and compliance with professional standards, when applicable.

(d) Record keeping for language training and testing, including usage of individual language training plans.

(e) Utilization of training resources, including communication of language training opportunities, availability of language resources and support for autonomous learning.

(f) Linguist retention and command incentives, such as command awards and recognition programs.

(g) Regular communication with command leadership including the CO or OIC, executive officer and senior enlisted leader and with key staff officers regarding command language program successes and failures in terms of program administration and mission readiness.

(2) Selection process and recognition. OPNAV N13F convenes a board to evaluate award submissions and make a final selection. The Navy-wide selection is announced annually and the selected package is forwarded to the Defense Language Institute Foreign Language Center to represent Navy at the DoD-level award program.

b. Individual Language Award Programs. Language award programs recognize AC, RC and civilian personnel who have distinguished themselves through use of foreign language skills to support Navy's mission. Award types, eligibility criteria, nomination procedures and selection processes are outlined in paragraphs 8b(1) through 8b(5).

(1) Language Professional of the Year. This category recognizes Sailors and Navy civilians whose occupational specialties (i.e. enlisted rating, officer designator or civilian job classification) require proficiency in a foreign language. Members serving in the CTI rating, in the FAO community or as civilian language specialists are eligible for consideration under the language professional category.

(a) Shannon M. Kent Award for Language Professional Excellence. Formerly known as the Language Professional of the Year Award, this award is renamed in honor of Senior Chief Cryptologic Technician Interpretive Shannon M. Kent.

1. Awarded the 2010 Navy Language Professional of the Year as a petty officer first class, Senior Chief Kent was recognized as an outstanding language analyst whose unparalleled language proficiency, cultural knowledge, technical acumen and leadership had proven paramount to the success of critical warfare missions in support of overseas contingency operations. She went on to be recognized as DoD Language Professional of the Year award that same year.

2. The Shannon M. Kent Award for Language Professional Excellence is awarded to an E-1 through E-6 Sailor from the CTI rating who emulates the professional standards and linguistic dedication demonstrated by Senior Chief Kent.

(b) Senior Language Professional of the Year. Eligible recipients are E-7 through E-9 Sailors from the CTI rating.

(c) Officer Language Professional of the Year. Eligible recipients are officers from FAO community.

(d) Civilian Language Professional of the Year. Eligible recipients are Navy civilian language specialists serving in positions, the primary duties of which are to administer, supervise or perform work in rendering the spoken or written word from a foreign language into English or from English into a foreign language (e.g., series 1040 or 1046 of the general schedule or general schedule, excepted service pay scales).

(2) Linguist of the Year (Non-language professional). This category recognizes personnel who have distinguished themselves while using foreign language skills, even though their primary duties do not require foreign language proficiency.

(a) Linguist of the Year. Eligible recipients are E-1 through E-6 Sailors serving in any rating other than CTI.

(b) Senior Linguist of the Year. Eligible recipients are E-7 through E-9 Sailors serving in any rating other than CTI.

(c) Officer Linguist of the Year. Eligible recipients are officers and warrant officers serving in communities other than FAO.

(d) Civilian Linguist of the Year. Eligible recipients are civilians serving in positions not designated as requiring a foreign language.

(3) Nomination procedures for individual language awards:

(a) Nominating activities and commands must ensure nominations are in the format specified in this instruction and forwarded via their type commanders or equivalent superior commands to OPNAV N13F at ALTN_N13F1@navy.mil. OPNAV N13F must receive nomination packages no later than 31 March for the previous fiscal year. Additional information on specific requirements, such as the essay topic, is provided annually as necessary.

(b) In addition to providing the information outlined in paragraphs 8b(1) through 8b(4), nomination packages should follow the guidance in enclosure (1) to this instruction.

1. CO's endorsement letter, including all subsequent endorsements, detailing the member's mission accomplishments, contributions to language readiness and training, personal self-improvement and any additional relevant information not specifically noted in this instruction.

2. For enclosure (1) of the nomination package, include official certification of current language proficiency for all tested languages.

3. For enclosure (2) of the nomination package, include an 8 inch by 10 inch, color, head and shoulders photograph of nominee in service dress uniform or appropriate civilian attire.

4. For enclosure (3) of the nomination package, include the nominee's essay. Essay topics are chosen annually, therefore, subject matter and content will be issued annually via separate correspondence.

5. For military submissions, enclosure (4) of the nomination package will include a draft OPNAV 1650/3 Personal Award Recommendation and a draft award citation consistent with the provisions of reference (b). OPNAV 1650/3 must include a written summary of the accomplishments leading to the member's nomination for the program.

(4) Selection Criteria. These awards recognize outstanding accomplishment using foreign language over the period of a fiscal year in support of command, Navy and DoD objectives. All nominees should demonstrate sustained superior performance and maintain the highest standards of the U.S. Navy. Packages are evaluated based specifically on:

(a) Nominee's contribution to successful mission accomplishment.

(b) Nominee's involvement in training (of others) and language readiness.

(c) Nominee's efforts in personal development and self-improvement.

(d) Senior language professional and senior linguist nominees in particular are evaluated for demonstration of personal linguistic excellence and significant contributions to improving the linguistic readiness of their Sailors, thereby enhancing the operational readiness of their commands.

(5) Selection process. OPNAV N13F convenes a board to evaluate award submissions and make final selections. OPNAV N13F forwards the package of the Sailor selected for the Shannon M. Kent Award for Language Professional Excellence (i.e. E-1 through E-6 CTI) to the DLIFLC to represent Navy in the DoD-level award program.

c. Recognition and Awards.

(1) Selections are announced via a public affairs announcement or NAVADMIN.

(2) Consistent with local command instructions and the guidelines in SECNAVINST 1650.1J, "Department of the Navy Military Awards Policy," type commanders or equivalents are

authorized to award the Navy Achievement Medal to their top military candidates not selected as a Navy-wide recipient. Civilians not selected as a Navy-wide recipient may be recognized at the command level consistent with command policy.

(3) Consistent with command policy, flag-level commanders below type commander or equivalent, are authorized to award Flag Letters of Commendation for their top candidates not selected at the type commander level.

(4) OPNAV N13F will process and forward Navy Commendation Medals for military selectees of each of the Navy-wide awards. Selectees for Navy-wide language recognition awards are not authorized to receive an award from the type commander or lower echelon for the same actions.

(5) OPNAV N13F will process and forward Letters of Commendation and certificates from the Navy Senior Language Authority for civilian selectees.

9. Coordination. CNO coordinator for command language programs and language awards is:

Navy Language, Regional Expertise and Culture Office (OPNAV N13F)
Naval Support Facility, Arlington
701 South Courthouse Road
Bldg 12, Room 3K030
Arlington, VA 22204

10. Records Management.

a. Records created as a result of this instruction, regardless of format or media, must be maintained and dispositioned per the records disposition schedules located on the Department of the Navy Assistant for Administration, Directives and Records Management Division portal page at <https://portal.secnav.navy.mil/orgs/DUSNM/DONAA/DRM/Records-and-Information-Management/Approved%20Record%20Schedules/Forms/AllItems.aspx>.

b. For questions concerning the management of records related to this instruction or the records disposition schedules, please contact the local records manager or the OPNAV Records Management Program (DNS-16).

11. Review and Effective Date. In line with reference OPNAVINST 5215.17A, Navy Directives Management Program, OPNAV N13F will review this instruction annually on the anniversary of its issuance date to ensure applicability, currency and consistency with Federal, DoD, Secretary of the Navy and Navy policy and statutory authority using OPNAV 5215/40, Review of Instruction. This instruction will be in effect for 10 years, unless revised or cancelled in the interim and will be reissued by the 10-year anniversary date if it is still required, unless it meets one of the exceptions in OPNAVINST 5215.17A, paragraph 9. Otherwise, if the instruction is no longer required, it will be processed for cancellation as soon as the need for cancellation is

known following the guidance in OPNAV Manual 5215.1 of May 2016, Navy Directives Management Program Manual.

12. Forms and Information Management Control.

- a. OPNAV 1650/3 Personal Award Recommendation is available for download from <https://awards.navy.mil>.
- b. Data collection contained within this instruction is exempt from information control per SECNAV Manual 5214.1 of December 2005 part IV paragraph 7 subparagraphs j and p.



JOHN B. NOWELL, JR.
Deputy Chief of Naval Operations
(Manpower, Personnel, Training and Education)

Releasability and distribution:

This instruction is cleared for public release and is available electronically only via Department of the Navy Issuances Web site, <https://www.secnav.navy.mil/doni/default.aspx>.

NAVY INDIVIDUAL LANGUAGE AWARDS - SAMPLE NOMINATION PACKAGE

1. Purpose. This enclosure provides general guidance on submitting a nomination package for the individual language awards described in this instruction.
2. Procedures. CO or OIC comments and endorsement, on letterhead, detailing the member's mission accomplishments, contributions to language readiness and training and personal self-improvement comprise the first section of the package. Exhibit 1 provides a sample nomination.

1650
Ser N00/XXX
DD Mmm YY

From: Commanding Officer, Unit
To: Navy Senior Language Authority (OPNAV N13F)
Via: Commander, Type Commander

Subj: FISCAL YEAR YYYY (AWARD CATEGORY) NOMINATION ICO [RATE OR DESIGNATOR] FIRST NAME MI. LAST NAME, USN

Ref: (a) OPNAVINST 5400.46A

Encl: (1) Language Proficiency Test Score(s) or Score Report ICO Nominee
(2) 8 x 10 Color Photo of Nominee
(3) Nominee's Essay
(4) OPNAV 1650/3 Personal Award Recommendation ICO Nominee and draft citation

1. Enclosures (1) through (4) are submitted for consideration for the Navy [Award Category Title].
2. Commanding officer's comments. Include a summary of the nominee's most significant linguistic accomplishments and their impact on the command and Navy's mission.
3. Commanding officer's endorsement and recommendation. Include a paragraph summarizing the nominee's qualities as a linguist and recommending selection for higher level and consideration.
4. My point of contact for this matter is [Name, phone, e-mail]

I. A. CAPTAIN

Exhibit 1: Sample Nomination Letter

Enclosure (1)

- a. Enclosure (1) of the nomination package must include official defense language proficiency test score(s).
- b. Include an 8 inch by 10 inch, color, head and shoulders photograph of the nominee in service uniform or appropriate civilian attire at enclosure (2) of the nomination package.
- c. Include the nominee's essay as enclosure (3). OPNAV N13F provides information about the essay topic annually. Essays should be typewritten, using 12-point font and must not exceed five double-spaced pages.
- d. Include an editable soft copy of OPNAV 1650/3 and draft citation for the nominee as enclosure (4).